Introduction

The Ultimate Completionist's Strategy Guide



Welcome, budding Pokémon trainers!

Welcome to the chilly, mysterious, and adventure-packed region of Sinnoh! Pokémon Platinum is the enhanced version of Pokémon Diamond and Pearl, first released for the Nintendo DS back in 2008. It takes everything we loved about the original Sinnoh adventures and cranks it up with a cooler story, some wicked battles, and new Pokémon to catch (hello, Rotom forms and the menacing Distortion World).

In this guide, we're going all-in on the completionist dream. That means:

- Catching 'em all (or at least everything the Sinnoh Regional Pokédex can hold before we go national)
- Tackling every side quest—from legendary Pokémon hunts to cool odd jobs like collecting rare items or helping NPCs in need
- Exploring every nook, cranny, cave, mountain, and creepy mansion Sinnoh has to offer
- Making sure you never miss a single thing. No hidden Pokémon, no one-time-only items, no stone left unturned

Pokémon Platinum is set in Sinnoh, a land inspired by Japan's northern island of Hokkaido, filled with snow-capped peaks, deep forests, ancient ruins, and modern cities humming with life. You'll meet quirky characters, challenge eight Gyms, square off against Team Galactic's bizarre schemes, and ultimately face the Pokémon League to become Champion. And because this is Platinum, you'll also confront Giratina, the mysterious Renegade Pokémon, in a twisted alternate dimension known as the Distortion World. But don't worry—you won't be alone on this journey. I'll be your trusty companion, keeping track of every new Pokémon, every route, and every hidden secret. Together, we'll squeeze every drop of content this game has to offer.

Introduction

The Ultimate Completionist's Strategy Guide

Whether you're brand new to Sinnoh or you're returning after years away, this guide will help you:

- Build a strong, diverse team
- Learn efficient routes to maximize encounters and item collection
- Enjoy the story without stressing about what you might be missing

Ready to embark on the most thorough Sinnoh adventure possible? Lace up those running shoes, make sure your Poké Balls are stocked, and let's head into the tall grass—because the world of Pokémon Platinum is just waiting to be completed.

What Makes Pokémon Platinum Special?

Platinum isn't just a slight upgrade—it's a revamped Sinnoh adventure with loads of new goodies for trainers to enjoy. Here's a quick look at what sets it apart:

- A Fresh Story Twist – Team Galactic's plot is reworked, adding Giratina's Distortion World and upping the drama.
- Expanded Pokédex – More Pokémon are available earlier, including favorites from other generations (Houndour, Togepi, Swablu, and more). This means better team variety right from the start.
- New Forms & Features – Shaymin's Sky Forme, Rotom's appliance forms, and Giratina's Origin Forme bring fresh strategies to battles.
- Battle Frontier – Postgame gets supercharged with a full suite of challenging battle facilities for you to test your skills.
- Updated Trainers & Gyms – Gym Leaders and the Elite Four have updated rosters, making for a better challenge throughout.
- Faster Gameplay – Some small but handy tweaks make the adventure flow smoother than in Diamond and Pearl (like faster surfing and more balanced level curves).

All in all, Platinum is the definitive Sinnoh experience—and if you're aiming to see and do it all, you picked the perfect version.

Chapter 1 - Twinleaf Town

The Beginning of Your Sinnoh Adventure

Welcome to Twinleaf Town!

Twinleaf Town is a quiet, snowy little settlement where our story begins. This place may look sleepy, but it's about to become the launchpad for your rise to Champion — and beyond. Here's what's happening: you and your energetic rival (Barry by default — you can name him whatever you like, even "HotPants" if you're feeling spicy) are itching to meet Professor Rowan in Sandgem Town. But you can't go waltzing through tall grass without a Pokémon, so naturally, you both attempt to do just that anyway… and hilarity ensues.

Professor Rowan shows up, scolds you for your reckless enthusiasm, then gives you the best gift any 10-year-old could hope for: your very first Pokémon.

Key events

• Your Journal – Mom gives you this to keep track of major events.

• Parcel – Barry's mom asks you to deliver it to him; part of the early errands.

• Running Shoes – You get these from your mom after starting the errand. From now on, no more slow walking!



Starter Pokémon

You'll get to pick one of these three Sinnoh starters:

Turtwig - Grass type - Grotle → Torterra
Bulky physical attacker; strong vs. Rock, Ground, Water.

Chimchar - Fire type - Monferno → Infernape
Fast mixed attacker; Fire/Fighting covers many types.

Piplup - Water type - Prinplup → Empoleon
Balanced with Steel typing late-game; good vs. Rock, Ground, Fire.

Starter Pokémon

The Beginning of Your Sinnoh Adventure

Your first big Decision

Picking a starter is like picking your first Pokémon partner-in-crime — they're with you through thick and thin, they'll carry a lot of early fights, and they'll shape your team's coverage for a while. Here's the good, the bad, and the quirky for each one:



Turtwig — Slow, Strong, Steadfast Tank

• Type Line: Grass → Grass/Ground (at Torterra)
• Stats Personality: High Attack and Defense, slow Speed.
• Notable Moves: Razor Leaf (early Grass STAB), Earthquake (amazing Ground STAB), Curse for setup.
• Strong against 4/8 gym leaders and weak against 1/8

Chimchar — Fast, Fiery Glass Cannon

• Type Line: Fire → Fire/Fighting (at Monferno).
• Stats Personality: Speedy, strong mixed attacker — best balance of offense in the trio.
• Notable Moves: Mach Punch (priority), Close Combat (monster Fighting STAB), Flamethrower/Fire Blast.
• Strong against 4/8 gym leaders and weak against 2/8

Piplup — Cool, Balanced Technician

• Type Line: Water → Water/Steel (at Empoleon).
• Stats Personality: Balanced bulk and Special Attack; a bit slower than average, but durable.
• Notable Moves: BubbleBeam → Surf (incredibly strong STAB), Ice Beam (later), Flash Cannon.
• Strong against only 1/8 gym leaders and weak against 2/8 but don't worry! You can build your team around these weaknesses!

Completionists note

• All starters can be used to a great effect. Don't worry too much about gym matchups!
• If you are filling your pokédex, You need another console and game to receive the other starters through trading.

Route 201

First route of your adventure

Your First Steps into Sinnoh

Welcome to Route 201, the very first stretch of adventure awaiting every new Trainer in Pokémon Platinum! This peaceful, grassy route connects your quiet Twinleaf Town to the bustling Sandgem Town. There are a few patches of grass here, perfect for getting your very first wild encounter experience.

You'll only find a handful of species, but these early companions can help you build a solid foundation for the road ahead. It's also a good place to practice catching Pokémon once you receive your Poké Balls from Lucas or Dawn. Unlike most routes, there are no trainers to battle here but we will start battling very soon!

This route might be small, but it marks the start of something big — your quest to become Sinnoh's ultimate Trainer! Below you can see the encounter table for this area. Basically it shows which wild pokémon can be found in the grass and how common they are. When a pokémon has a bold name, it means that it is available for the first time in this guide so pay attention to those if you are trying to fill your pokédex! We will be using this same format for this whole guide.

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Starly	normal/flying	2-3	50%
Bidoof	normal	2-3	40%
Kricketot	bug	3	10%

Completionists note

- Kricketot can only be found during morning
- Bidoof learns a lot of hidden machine moves which will be useful later
- Starly is a popular pokémon that is often added to teams



Sandgem Town and Route 202

First Steps as an Official Pokémon Trainer

You've made it to Sandgem Town, and now things really open up. You'll meet Professor Rowan in his lab, officially receive your Pokédex, and get your first batch of Poké Balls — congratulations, you can finally start catching Pokémon!
Rowan will also introduce his assistant, Dawn (or Lucas, if you're playing as Dawn). This is your friendly counterpart, different from your rival Barry — they'll give you a few tutorials, and eventually the essential TM27 (Return), which powers up as your Pokémon's friendship grows.

Sandgem Town highlights

• Pokédex & Poké Balls — Now you can actually start filling in those empty Dex slots.

• PC & Pokémon Center — Healing, storage, and trading become available.

• Poké Mart — Stock up on Poké Balls, Potions, and Antidotes. You'll need them for the next stretch.

• Tutorial Catch — Dawn/Lucas demonstrates how to catch Pokémon on Route 202. Nothing fancy, but counts as part of the early-game charm. Before you can do the tutorial, you have to go back to Twinleaf to visit your mom.

Route 202 – First Trainer Battles, First Real Catches

This grassy route connects Sandgem Town to Jubilife City. It's home to your first real trainer battles (four youngsters with low-level Pokémon) and some decent wild Pokémon to fill out your team. Here's what you can find:

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Starly	normal/flying	2-4	20%
Bidoof	normal	2-3	40%
Kricketot	bug	3	10% (morning/night)
Shinx	electric	3-4	30%

Jubilife city

From Quiet Towns to the Big City

Welcome to Jubilife City, the biggest metropolis in western Sinnoh and your first major stop after earning your Trainer status. Sitting proudly between Route 202, Route 203, and Route 218, Jubilife buzzes with life, technology, and opportunities — it's where the adventure truly starts to branch out. You won't find a Gym here, but you'll find just about everything else: education, gadgets, and side content galore.

What to Do in Jubilife City

1. The Trainer's School
Just east of the Pokémon Center, this is a great spot to pick up a few early battle tips. You'll also meet your rival here and give him the parcel that contains a few handy Town Maps for your trouble. Two students inside are eager for friendly battles — they're optional, but a good warm-up

2. Pokétch Company Headquarters
On the north side of the city sits the Pokétch Company, makers of the Pokémon Watch. To get one, you'll need to win the Clown Coupon Hunt! Talk to the three clowns around town — they'll quiz you on basic Pokémon knowledge. Once you collect all three coupons, return to the company president to receive your Pokétch. It's more than just a watch; it can display maps, friendship levels, step counters, and much more.



Completionists note

Before heading east towards route 203 there are some optional things to do while you are here:

• Daily lottery in the TV station

• Get the old rod from a fisherman in the western exit of the city. This can be used to fish Magikarp almost anywhere where there is water.

- Receive quick claw from the building in the northeastern corner of the city.
- Visit Route 204 for some extra experience early. We will be going through that area a bit later in the guide.

Route 203

Rival Battle Ahead!

Here's your first true rival fight. Barry (your rival) will challenge you here before you can move on toward Oreburgh City. Barry will have the following pokémon:
Starly - Level 7 - Weak Flying-type - watch for Quick Attack spam.
Starter (depends on what your starter is) level 9 - Will have a STAB move and a basic coverage move; treat seriously.
They're still low-level, but if you're underleveled it might be tough. This fight sets the tone — Barry is fast, not cautious. It is recommended to have at least 2 team members at this point including your starter. Overall this fight should be very manageable by simply using your strongest moves.

After the battle, trainers dot the roadside, eager to challenge passing adventurers. It's a good place to test the strength of your growing team and prepare for what's to come. Wild Pokémon here are a little tougher than before and there is a handful of new ones to find. At the far end of the route, the trail narrows into the dark mouth of Oreburgh Gate, a cave that marks the boundary of civilization.

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Starly	normal/flying	4-7	25%
Bidoof	normal	5-7	15%
Kricketot	bug	5	10% (morning/night)
Shinx	electric	4-5	25%
abra	psychic	4-5	15%
zubat	poison/flying	4	10% (night)

- Abra can make for a powerful team member, but requires trading to evolve it into Alakazam
- Zubat is a common pokemon that can be found in most caves so it is not a mandatory catch

Oreburgh Gate and City

Sinnoh's mining hub

Before you can reach Oreburgh city, you have to go through Oreburgh gate. Shortly after entering, you'll meet a friendly Hiker who gives you HM06 Rock Smash, one of your first Hidden Machines. Although you can't use it outside of battle yet, it's a clear signal that you'll soon need it — and that means a Gym Challenge is on the horizon. Within the cave, you'll find a few trainers testing their Pokémon's strength, along with items like Poké Balls and Potions tucked away in corners as well as the following wild pokémon:

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Geodude	rock/ground	5-7	15%
Zubat	poison/flying	5-8	50%
Psyduck	water	5-7	35%

Oreburgh City

Oreburgh City is a rugged, dust-coated town where everything revolves around rocks, coal, and hardworking miners. It's home to Oreburgh Mine, a massive excavation site that provides the city's lifeblood — and the perfect training ground for Rock-type specialists.
At the northern edge stands the Oreburgh Gym, led by Roark, the first Gym Leader you'll face. He's a Rock-type expert and a miner himself, known for his sturdy defense and use of Fossil Pokémon. Before you can challenge him, however, you'll have to track him down in the Oreburgh Mine which will be your next main objective.

Things to do in Oreburgh city

- Explore the city! You can get some items just by talking to people.
- In one of the northern buildings, you can find a trainer who will trade you an Abra in exchange for a Machop. Machop can be found on route 207.
- Visit route 207. There aren't any trainers but you can find a wild Ponyta and Machop. They could make for powerful team members.
- You can revive fossils in the mining museum. At this point you won't have any yet but keep this in mind when you eventually find one (we will be covering that in this guide later on).

Oreburgh Mine & Route 205

Training and Exploration

Before taking on Roark at the Oreburgh Gym, Oreburgh Mine is a crucial spot to explore and prepare. This mine isn't just a story checkpoint — it's a mini training ground and a place to pick up some early items.I nside, you'll see miners hard at work, rubble blocking certain paths, and wild Rock- and Ground-type Pokémon lurking in the shadows. You can battle a few trainers here who provide solid experience for your early team. At the end you will find Roark. Talk to him and he will be heading back to the Gym, so you can challenge him.

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Geodude	rock/ground	6-9	65%
Zubat	poison/flying	6-8	25%
Onix	rock/ground	7-9	10%

Route 207 - Optional Exploration and Team Building

Route 207 lies just north of Oreburgh City and provides a few useful opportunities before your first Gym battle. It's a quiet, slightly hilly route with a patch of grass and a few items tucked away, making it a good place to round out your team. Most of the route is currently unaccessible but we can still catch some pokémon. Route 207 isn't required to progress to the Gym, but it's a convenient spot to train, stock up, and catch a few new Pokémon to give you an edge against Rock-types. With Oreburgh Mine cleared and a few battles on Route 207 under your belt, your team should be ready to challenge Roark and earn your first badge!

Pokémon	Type	Level	Encounter %
Geodude	rock/ground	5-7	30%
Machop	fighting	6-8	35%
Ponyta	fire	5-7	25%
Kricketot	bug	5	10% (morning night)

Oreburgh Gym

Roark's Rock-Solid Challenge

The Oreburgh Gym is the first real test for any Sinnoh Trainer.Located in the heart of Oreburgh City, it doubles as both a challenge and a tutorial for type advantages, strategy, and preparation. Roark, the Gym Leader, is a miner through and through, and his team is entirely Rock-type, meaning they have high Defense and are resistant to Normal-, Flying-, and Fire-type attacks. However, Grass- and Water-type moves hit them for super effective damage. Additionally they are also weak to ground, fighting and steel so if you have any of those attacks they will be extra powerful. Lets go over Roark's team:



Pokémon	Type	Level	Moves
Geodude	rock/ground	12	Stealth Rock Rock Throw Rock Polish Mud Sport
Onix	rock/ground	12	Stealth Rock Rock Throw Screech Bind
Cranidos	rock	14	Headbutt Pursuit Leer

Roark can use 2 potions during the battle when his pokémon's HP drops to 25% or less. You should be able to easily defeat him with your stater. On the next page we will go through strategies for the battle.

Oreburgh Gym strategies

Roark's Rock-Solid Challenge

Strategies

Starter

Each starter should be able to win by using a stab move. Your level should be around 15 or 16 so chimchar should be evolved by now. This is important because it learnes Mach Punch. It is a fighting type move that hits all of Roark's pokémon super effectively. With Piplup/Prinplup use Bubblebeam and Turtwig should use Razor Leaf. If you get flinched by Cranidos' headbutt, use potions to keep yourself in the match.

Other pokémon

If your starter goes down during the match or if you aren't using it in your team, there are other pokémon that are strong against rock types too.

- Budew - This baby pokémon can hit rock types super effectively with grass type moves like Absorb and Mega Drain
- Psyduck - Super effective with Water Gun
- Machop - Super effective with fighting type moves
- Defensive pokemon like Onix and Geodude who resist rock and normal moves

After the battle

Congratulations, Trainer! You've just hammered through your first Gym battle and earned the Coal Badge — your very first step on the road to Sinnoh's Pokémon League! Roark might've looked intimidating with his mining gear and rock-solid lineup, but you've proven that your team can handle real competition. Let's go through what happens next and what you can do before leaving Oreburgh City:

- The Coal Badge — This allows you to use Rock Smash outside of battle, opening up a number of new areas to explore.
- TM76: Stealth Rock — A tactical Rock-type move that damages any Pokémon that switch into battle. It's a staple in competitive play, but not immediately vital for your adventure team

As you exit the Gym, you'll be reminded to report back to Jubilife City. There's some commotion there involving Team Galactic, and you'll need to intervene. That brings this chapter to a close.